

Russell Dudek

AI & Automation Operator | Systems Integration | Operational Transformation

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Alex Hyduke, Human Resource Manager
Delaware Valley Companies
Audubon, Pennsylvania / Tampa, Florida

Dear Alex,

Delaware Valley Companies is not hiring its first Head of AI & Automation to produce an AI roadmap. It is hiring someone to remove operational drag while the business scales - beginning where estimate assumptions, project records, field evidence, approvals, and financial systems cross organizational boundaries.

That mandate fits the through-line of my career. At Vape-Jet, I work directly across production, purchasing, quality, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows to make complex operating work visible and actionable. Through DudeWorth, I design AI-readiness and agentic workflow patterns that connect business value, structured context, human authority, evaluation, and governance. At Amazon, I built operating cadence, standard work, visibility, and escalation in a 24/7 logistics environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. At Compunetics, I led high-reliability engineering, manufacturing, quality, and process-control work where weak handoffs had real consequences.

I would approach Delaware Valley's first six to twelve months as a hands-on builder: sit with estimators and project managers, follow work into the field, identify the authoritative records and exception owners, then build the smallest production mechanism that removes rekeying and improves decisions. My candidate vision at russelldudek.github.io/delawarepaving makes that reasoning visible through a Load-Bearing Workflow model, a detailed 120-day entry plan, and an Automation Load Test for deciding what is ready to automate versus what must be stabilized first.

The strongest reasonable concern is that I have not spent my career inside a paving contractor, and I do not claim direct NetSuite or Microsoft Graph production ownership that is not supported by my experience. I would not hide that gap. I would bring construction humility, a pattern of rapidly learning operational systems, hands-on ERP and workflow modernization, programming and data fluency, and disciplined integration thinking. I would expect the interview to test the technical depth and learning plan directly.

I am currently based in Pittsburgh and am already planning to relocate to the Tampa / St. Petersburg region. Tampa aligns with my long-term plans, and during the transition I can support the required in-office cadence in Audubon. For this role, that proximity is an operating advantage: the work will be won in direct observation, trust, and iteration with the people whose workflows are changing.

I welcome the opportunity to discuss where Delaware Valley sees the greatest operational load today and what a credible first production win would need to prove.

Sincerely,
Russell Dudek